

Hikvision ISAPI Developer Guide - Executive Summary

Overview

The ISAPI Developer Guide documents the REST-style APIs exposed by Hikvision cameras, NVRs, and DVRs. It enables external applications to monitor, configure, and control Hikvision devices using HTTP requests with Digest Authentication.

Core Features

Device management, storage management, event notifications, live video, playback, recording search, user management, PTZ control, networking, and system configuration.

Most Useful APIs

- GET /ISAPI/System/deviceInfo – Device model, serial, firmware.
- GET /ISAPI/System/status – Overall device status.
- GET /ISAPI/ContentMgmt/Storage/hdd – HDD details.
- GET /ISAPI/System/workingstatus/hdStatus – HDD health.
- GET /ISAPI/System/workingstatus/chanStatus – Camera status.
- GET /ISAPI/Event/notification/alertStream – Real-time events.
- POST /ISAPI/ContentMgmt/search – Recording search.
- GET /ISAPI/Streaming/channels/101/picture – Snapshot.

Supported Events

Motion Detection, Line Crossing, Intrusion Detection, People Counting, Video Loss, Camera Offline, HDD Failure, HDD Temperature, Tamper Alarm, Audio Alarm, White Light Alarm, and more.

Storage Features

HDD information, SMART tests, bad sector tests, formatting, storage quotas, and health monitoring.

Authentication

Uses HTTP Digest Authentication. Many endpoints support XML by default and JSON using ?format=json.

Recommended Monitoring Dashboard

Monitor device information, HDD health, camera online/offline status, recording status, firmware, storage usage, and subscribe to the alert stream for real-time notifications.

Conclusion

The guide is a comprehensive API reference. For monitoring systems, the most valuable sections are Device Information, Storage Management, Working Status, and Event Notifications.